PassFrame
TUITION

The Boy Who Collected Clouds

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Theo did not collect stamps or marbles like the other boys in his class. Theo collected clouds — or rather, he collected words for them, scribbled into a battered green notebook he carried everywhere he went.

'Today,' he wrote, lying flat on his back in the school field, 'a cloud shaped exactly like a galloping horse, with a mane of wispy white threads trailing behind it.' Beside him, his notebook flapped gently in the breeze, pages soft from being turned so many times.

Some of the other children laughed when they saw him staring up at the sky instead of playing football. 'What's the point of writing about clouds?' sneered Marcus from Year 5. 'They just float away and disappear.'

Theo didn't have an answer that day, but that evening his grandmother found him curled up on the sofa, flicking through his notebook with a troubled frown. 'Everything beautiful floats away eventually,' she said gently, settling beside him. 'That's exactly why it's worth writing down.'

Theo thought about this for a long time. The next morning, he returned to the school field with his notebook as always — only now, when Marcus asked his question again, Theo simply smiled and said, 'That's exactly the point.'

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. Where was Theo lying when he described the cloud shaped like a horse?

2. What did Theo compare the trailing part of the cloud to?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you other children thought Theo's hobby was strange.

4. Underline the sentence that shows Theo's grandmother noticed he was upset.

5. What does “troubled” suggest about Theo's frown that evening?

6. Put these events in order: Theo's grandmother speaks to him / Marcus laughs at Theo / Theo writes about the horse-shaped cloud / Theo returns to the field the next day.

7. Why might the author have given Theo's notebook the detail of being “battered” and “soft from being turned so many times”?

8. What was Marcus's opinion of clouds, based on what he said?

9. Why do you think Theo didn't have an answer for Marcus on the first day?

10. What does Theo's final reply to Marcus suggest has changed in how he thinks?

11. Find and copy a word that means “made fun of in an unkind way”.

12. Write one or two sentences describing a fleeting (short-lived) thing you think would be worth writing about, and why.